



Well deserved: Carolina Marin clinched her second title at the All England Open. **Below:** Paris singles gold medallist An Se-Young. GETTY IMAGES

Thailand Opens.

Sindhu ended her two-year title drought by clinching the Syed Modi International singles crown. Elsewhere, the women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand — India's sole representatives at the BWF World Tour Finals — secured their maiden Super 300 title while Lakshya Sen also concluded the year on a high, winning the men's singles title at the same tournament.



IN 2025...

Whether the much-loved Premier Badminton League (PBL) will return remains uncertain. Discussions about reviving the tournament surfaced early last year, but the final decision now rests with BAI secretary Sanjay Mishra.

Moreover, BWF announced India as the host for this year's World Junior Championships. The tournament will be held in Guwahati, marking the second time India will host the event, the first instance being in Pune in 2008.

A rejuvenated Sindhu, fresh off her long-awaited title win, could potentially return to her best form. Similarly, Lakshya Sen, following his stellar run at the Olympics, may continue to shine on the global stage. The women's doubles duo of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand could also carry forward their momentum from their impressive performances at the World Tour Finals.

With major tournaments like the All England Open and the World Championships on the calendar, the focus will be on which Indian shuttlers — or perhaps a rising foreign star — will rise to the occasion and deliver standout performances.